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Continental Finance

Twilio Bulk Messaging Demo

Presenter Guide · Step-by-step run of book

Prepared for: Amplix + Continental Finance RFP evaluation
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Purpose & flow

This demo answers Continental Finance's SMS RFP by proving three of the four core use cases live against Twilio's Programmable Messaging API. It runs 15–20 minutes end-to-end.

The fourth use case (business-user campaign administration) is addressed as a talk-track in this document — Twilio Console covers most of it honestly, and we concede the one gap explicitly.

THREE USE CASES, ONE BROWSER, ONE CELL PHONE

Use Case 1 Payment reminder — fire-and-forget via Create Message + Compliance Toolkit Quiet Hours enforcement.

Use Case 2 Message pull-back — schedule + cancel via Update Message with Status=canceled.

Use Case 3 Response & opt-out — Advanced Opt-Out + free-form capture + DNC.

WHAT YOU'LL ASK THEM TO NOTICE

- Compliance Toolkit enforces TCPA + state Quiet Hours per recipient — Continental Finance stops doing timezone math in their scheduler.
- messageIntent tags each send so essential (notifications, OTP, fraud) bypasses Quiet Hours and non-essential (marketing) is auto-rescheduled.
- Per-message MessageSid — every send is individually addressable, cancellable, and auditable.
- Cancel-in-flight via Update Message with Status=canceled while message is still scheduled.
- STOP/START/HELP handled natively via Advanced Opt-Out — zero code.
- Free-form inbound captured for human review — real cross-sender DNC.
- At 3.5M/mo (~4/sec average), fan-out fits comfortably inside short-code throughput (100 MPS).

Pre-flight checklist

Complete all six before the demo starts. Total time: ~2 minutes.

STEP 1 Server up on :3001

Terminal 1: `cd ~/Documents/ContinentalFinanceBulkDemo && node server.js`

Watch for: "Continental Finance Bulk Messaging Demo running on http://localhost:3001". No missing env-var warnings.

STEP 2 ngrok tunnel up

Terminal 2: `ngrok http 3001 --url sasmith.ngrok.app`

Browser test: `https://sasmith.ngrok.app/api/queue` should return JSON (may 307 through ngrok abuse page — fine, Twilio's webhook UA bypasses it).

STEP 3 Messaging Service inbound webhook

Console !' Messaging !' Services !' your Surge service !' Integration !' Inbound Webhook URL = `https://sasmith.ngrok.app/webhooks/twilio/inbound`. Method: POST.

STEP 4 Advanced Opt-Out configured

Same service !' Opt-Out Management !' Advanced enabled. Custom Surge STOP copy set (see appendix for suggested wording). Keywords: STOP/START/HELP.

STEP 4b Compliance Toolkit enabled

Console !' Messaging !' Services !' your Surge service !' Compliance Toolkit !' Enabled. Quiet Hours handling = Reschedule (default). This is what makes Use Case 1's fire-and-forget pitch true; without CT enabled, messages fire immediately regardless of local time.

STEP 5 Dashboard open

Browser: `http://localhost:3001` — you should see the Continental Finance SMS Operations header and three Use Case tabs (1, 2, 3).

STEP 6 Cell in hand, signal confirmed

You'll text to the Surge long code from your cell during Use Case 3. Test with a single "test" text before the demo starts — it will show up in the Inbound stream and you'll know the round-trip works.

Fallback: if ngrok flakes or Twilio 5xx during the demo, you have a screen-recorded backup take. Do not attempt to fix live — pivot to the recording and keep talking.

Use Case 1 · Fire and Forget · Compliance Toolkit

RFP use case 1: high-volume payment reminder + past-due messaging. Target: 3 minutes.

Open on Use Case 1 tab

Say: "Continental Finance sends three-point-five million payment reminders a month, from short codes, in a self-defined 8-to-9 window that they run in Eastern Time. That means cardholders in Pacific Time can receive messages at 5 AM local — a TCPA violation nobody meant to make. Watch what happens when Twilio's Compliance Toolkit is on the path."

STEP 1 Click "Send now"

Dashboard hits our server. Server calls `client.messages.create()` with the Messaging Service SID, the personalized body, and `messageIntent="marketing"` — no `scheduleType`, no `sendAt`. Continental Finance is not doing any timezone math on their side.

Say: "One API call, one MessageSid. The important thing is what happens next."

STEP 2 Compliance Toolkit evaluates Quiet Hours per recipient

Twilio takes the outbound message, infers the recipient's local timezone from area code — or from a ZIP code if Continental Finance provides it via Contact API — and checks against TCPA quiet hours (9 PM to 8 AM local) plus state-specific overlays for Alabama, Florida, Louisiana, Maryland, Mississippi, Oklahoma, Tennessee, Washington, Connecticut, Nevada, and Texas.

Say: "If the send is inside quiet hours for that cardholder, Twilio auto-reschedules the message for the next allowed window. Status returns as "scheduled" with a ScheduledAt timestamp. If it is outside quiet hours, delivered immediately. Continental Finance sees the outcome and does not have to compute any of it."

STEP 3 Status card shows what happened

For the demo — during business hours — you will most likely see `queued !' sending !' sent !' delivered` because it is not quiet hours anywhere in the US. Point at the `messageIntent` field in the raw API panel and say: this is what tells CT how to classify the message.

Say: "The value here is what you don't see: Continental Finance's scheduler does not need to segment by timezone. It does not need to know that Sunday in Texas has different rules. Twilio enforces the federal TCPA baseline plus every state overlay Twilio supports, per recipient, on every message. Zero code."

Compliance judgment call

Payment reminders sit on a line. Twilio's Compliance Toolkit treats OTP, fraud alerts, notifications, customer support, security alerts, and delivery updates as essential (bypass Quiet Hours). It treats marketing, events, education, polling, announcements as non-essential (Quiet Hours enforced).

Continental Finance's counsel decides which bucket a payment reminder falls into. Two defensible choices:

- Classify as notifications (essential): CT delivers immediately regardless of time. Continental Finance retains responsibility for FDCPA 8am–9pm local windowing themselves.
- Classify as marketing (non-essential): CT enforces TCPA + state Quiet Hours automatically. Continental Finance offloads that timing enforcement to Twilio.

The demo uses "marketing" so the CT evaluation is visibly on the path. For the RFP response we present

both options and let their compliance team pick.

If they push back on removing scheduling

The Message Scheduling capability is still there — `scheduleType=fixed` + `sendAt` on the same Create Message endpoint, minimum 15 min lead, maximum 7 days. Continental Finance can use it for coordinated blasts where they want an explicit send time (e.g., a statement-day 10am local across all cardholders). Not the primary pitch, but available.

Say: "If they specifically want to see it, we can trigger the same endpoint with a `sendAt` parameter — no code change on our side, just a different curl. But the CT path is the stronger story: less code on their side, better TCPA posture out of the box."

Use Case 2 · Message Pull-back (Payment-Triggered Cancel)

RFP use case 2: "receive payment/account updates quickly enough to remove customers from active campaigns and prevent unnecessary reminders after payment." Target: 4 minutes.

Open Use Case 2 tab

Say: "Continental Finance's current lag from payment to suppression is about fifteen minutes. Payment posts, but the SMS provider does not know about it in time, and the reminder still fires. Watch how message pull-back on Programmable Messaging closes that gap for scheduled sends."

STEP 1 Click "Schedule Jane's reminder (20 min from now)"

Our server calls `POST /2010-04-01/Accounts/{Sid}/Messages.json` with `scheduleType=fixed`, `sendAt=+20min`, and the Messaging Service SID. Twilio returns a `MessageSid` and `status=scheduled`. Jane's row in the queue table shows the `MessageSid`; status badge flips to "Scheduled" (blue). The Twilio Console link lights up on the right so you can verify Twilio's view of the state.

Say: "Twilio now holds this message on its schedule. It will fire in twenty minutes unless we cancel it first. Every cardholder scheduled the same way gets their own MessageSid — no batch handle, no shared operationId. Each message is independently addressable."

STEP 2 Click "Payment posted !" cancel scheduled SMS"

Simulates Continental Finance's payment system firing a webhook — `POST /webhooks/payment` with `{phone, accountId, amount, postedAt}`. Our server looks up Jane's `MessageSid`, then calls `POST /2010-04-01/Accounts/{Sid}/Messages/{MessageSid}.json` with `Status=canceled`. Twilio returns `status=canceled`. The queue row flips to "Canceled" (red).

Say: "That was one API call to pull back one specific message. Update Message with Status=canceled. Twilio drops the scheduled SMS before it ever reaches the carrier. At Continental Finance's scale, this is the pattern: payment webhook fires, server looks up the MessageSid for that cardholder, cancel API call goes out. Millisecond latency, per-cardholder precision."

STEP 3 Verify in Twilio Console

Click the "Open in Twilio Console" link on the right side of the scene. Console !' Monitor !' Logs !' Messaging shows the `MessageSid` with `status=canceled`. Refresh to confirm.

Say: "That is the audit record. Continental Finance's compliance team, or Amplix during their review, can walk this trail for any message: scheduled at X, canceled at Y, never delivered. No cardholder ever saw the past-due reminder they had already paid."

Honest note on the cancellation window

Cancellation is only available while `status = scheduled`. Twilio moves scheduled messages to `queued` approximately 15 minutes before `sendAt`. After that, `Update Message` returns error 30409 and the message is committed.

Practical implication for Continental Finance: design schedule lead time so there is always a cancel window before send. If a payment can post right up to the reminder fire time, schedule at least 15 minutes into the future.

Say: "This is documented behavior. If evaluators ask what happens if payment posts fourteen minutes before send: Twilio returns error thirty-thousand-four-oh-nine, the message is already committed to

queue. Design your lead time accordingly."

Use Case 3 · Response & Opt-Out

RFP use case 3: capture every inbound, handle STOP compliantly, review the rest, block on request. Target: 5 minutes. Two things happen here — the automated path (STOP/START/HELP handled entirely by Twilio) and the manual path (free-form text captured for a human).

Open Use Case 3 tab

Say: "Every SMS platform has to handle inbound messages from customers. There are two flavors: the compliance-critical keywords like STOP, and everything else. Watch how Twilio handles each."

STEP 1 PART A — Text "STOP" from your cell to the Surge long code

Within 1–2 seconds:

- Twilio auto-replies with your custom Surge confirmation copy — no code on your side.
- A red-bordered row appears in the Inbound Stream: "Advanced Opt-Out · STOP".
- The activity log narrates the OptOutType=STOP event with a link to the Twilio doc.
- Twilio adds your cell to its block list.

Say: "That reply, that block-list entry, that audit record — all handled by Twilio's Advanced Opt-Out feature on the Messaging Service. You configured the reply copy once in Console. No downstream sync, no code, no risk of missing a STOP."

STEP 2 PART A — Prove the block by trying to send again

Click the Use Case 1 tab. Click "Send now". The activity log will show Twilio accepted the request but the response will surface error 21610 — attempt to send to unsubscribed recipient — and the Delivered counter for your cell does not increment.

Say: "Continental's STOP compliance is now enforced at the Twilio edge. Even a rogue downstream send is blocked before it leaves. That's a compliance posture your incumbent can't match without your engineers writing the enforcement themselves."

STEP 3 PART A — Text "START" to re-opt

Back on Use Case 3. Text START from your cell. Twilio auto-replies with the re-opt confirmation. Row appears: "Advanced Opt-Out · START". Number is removed from Twilio's block list. Future sends go through.

Say: "Same automation for opt-in. Same audit trail. Same zero code."

Use Case 3 · continued

STEP 4 PART B — Text "please stop bugging me" from your cell

This is NOT a keyword. Twilio doesn't classify it. Twilio delivers the raw text to our inbound webhook. An amber-bordered row appears in the Inbound Stream: "Free-form (needs human review)".

Say: "Every SMS platform has this problem: cardholders don't always say STOP. They say "quit texting me," or "I paid this last week," or "wrong number." Your incumbent misses these because it only classifies the exact word STOP. Watch what Twilio does."

STEP 5 PART B — Click "Add to DNC" on that row

The row moves. The Do-Not-Contact panel on the right lists that number. Timeline in the activity log stamps the addition.

Say: "That number is now on our app-side Do-Not-Contact list. This is a suppression layer that Continental controls — separate from Twilio's Advanced Opt-Out block list. Two important reasons."

One: it works across every sender you ever add. If you buy a second Surge number tomorrow, the DNC still applies. That's the cross-sender governance the RFP explicitly asks for. Two: it lets a compliance officer intervene proactively — for example, adding a number after a support call, or a complaint routed through Genesys.

STEP 6 PART B — Prove the DNC block by trying to send again

Click the Use Case 1 tab. Click "Send now". The response payload will show "blockedByDnc": [<your cell>]. The send never leaves our server — Twilio isn't even called for that number.

Say: "That's defense in depth. Twilio blocks at the edge for STOP. We block before the API call for our own DNC list. Cardholders don't receive messages they asked us to stop."

Honest concession on re-opt: Twilio's Advanced Opt-Out block list is Console-managed. There is no public REST API to remove a number from that block list — the customer must text START. If Continental wants programmatic re-opt for support-desk workflows, that's a Support case or a manual Console action.

RFP use case 4 · Business-user administration (talk-track)

No live UI. This is the section you present with slides on the projector when the evaluation team asks about business-user self-service.

BUSINESS USERS SELF-SERVE FOR

- DNC / suppression list management via Messaging > Advanced Opt-Out (Console).
- Opt-out confirmation wording — the custom Surge copy is editable in Console without a code deploy.
- Sender Pool / Messaging Service configuration — add or remove numbers, change routing rules.
- Scheduling adjustments and pausing campaigns — Programmable Messaging scheduling window from 15 min to 7 days out.
- Delivery monitoring, alerts, reports — Console + Insights + Event Streams for BI destinations.
- User & role management via Twilio IAM for tenant-scoped access.

WHERE WE CONCEDE HONESTLY

Changing SMS body copy itself still requires an application code change. Twilio does not ship a business-user editor for SMS body text.

If Continental Finance wants a business-user-facing content editor on top of Programmable Messaging, that is a scoped services engagement — quoted separately. We won't fake it in this demo.

Say: "The RFP explicitly asks for business-user self-service without IT code changes. For everything except message body copy, Console + IAM cover it. For message body copy, you get a services engagement price with a real Twilio partner. That is honest, and if that gap is the deal-breaker, we'll size the services engagement in the follow-up."

Honest concessions summary

You will get asked. Answer directly.

BUSINESS-USER SMS BODY EDITOR

Twilio does not ship this. Console covers DNC, sender config, opt-out wording, scheduling, monitoring — but NOT body copy. Body copy edits are a code change, or a services engagement to build a content editor on top of Programmable Messaging.

PROGRAMMATIC RE-OPT FROM TWILIO BLOCK LIST

Advanced Opt-Out block list is Console-managed. No public REST API to remove numbers from that block list. Customer texts START, or Support intervenes.

GENESYS INTEGRATION

Continental's contact center is entirely Genesys. Twilio is not competing to replace it. If agents ever need SMS visibility inside Genesys, that's a services integration — not part of this demo.

Appendix · Suggested Advanced Opt-Out copy

STOP confirmation

You've been unsubscribed from Surge Mastercard reminders.
Reply START to resubscribe. For help, reply HELP.

START confirmation

You're re-subscribed to Surge Mastercard reminders.
Msg&data rates may apply. Reply STOP to opt out.

HELP reply

Surge Mastercard from Continental Finance.
Call 1-877-xxx-xxxx for cardholder services.
Msg&data rates may apply. Reply STOP to opt out.

Appendix · Sample Programmable Messaging payloads

Immediate send

```
POST /2010-04-01/Accounts/{AccountSid}/Messages.json
```

```
messagingServiceSid = MG...  
to = +15551234567  
body = "Hi Jane, this is a reminder that your Surge Mastercard ending in 4832 has a  
payment of $47.50 due on Sep 15. Reply STOP to opt out."
```

Scheduled send (15 min – 7 days out)

```
POST /2010-04-01/Accounts/{AccountSid}/Messages.json
```

```
messagingServiceSid = MG...  
to = +15551234567  
body = "Hi Jane, this is a reminder..."  
scheduleType = fixed  
sendAt = 2026-09-12T14:00:00Z
```

Returns MessageSid + status=scheduled.

Cancel a scheduled message

```
POST /2010-04-01/Accounts/{AccountSid}/Messages/{MessageSid}.json
```

Status = canceled

Returns status=canceled. Only valid while message is in scheduled status; returns error 30409 otherwise.